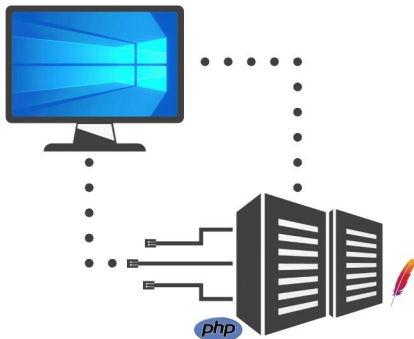


Setting Up Apache and PHP on Windows

Developers can easily run or test their scripts in Windows before they put them out on the Internet, if they have Apache and PHP installed on their systems. This article is a tutorial on how Apache and PHP can be set up in Windows.



Web servers are computers that are usually set up in a facility called a data centre. These servers are maintained and operated by hosting companies, to store websites, so that people can visit them on the Internet. The files stored on a Web server are read by browsers, which convert these files into images and text for viewing. Your browser communicates with the Web server to bring you information from the Internet. The purpose of Web servers is to *serve* files, as requested. A server can send the same file, or a different one, to hundreds of users at the same time.

Web server software

Web servers typically run two types of operating systems—Linux or Microsoft Windows. Most of the Web servers today operate on Linux and most websites are hosted by Linux servers. It is confusing that these software programs are also referred to as servers. So you must distinguish between servers that refer to hardware and those that refer to software. Web servers also run other software programs in the background. Such software is useful for creating websites.

Basically, the Web server software receives your request to access a Web page. It runs a few security checks on your

HTTP request and takes you to the Web page requested. Depending on the page you have requested, the server may be asked to run a few extra modules while generating the document to serve you. It then serves you the document you requested. The process is an example of the client/server model. All computers that host websites must have Web server programs and Apache is one such program.

An introduction to Apache

Apache is the most widely used Web server software. Developed and maintained by the Apache Software Foundation, it is open source software available for free. It can be highly customised to meet the needs of diverse environments through the use of extensions and modules. Most WordPress hosting providers use Apache as their Web server software.

The Apache HTTP server is software (or a program) that runs in the background under an appropriate operating system; it supports multi-tasking, and provides services to other applications that connect to it, such as client Web browsers. It was first developed to work with Linux/UNIX operating systems, but was later adapted to work under other